Micropolis Eduverse Project



Update: 26.3.2009

Project Started: Nov 2008

Overview

Original goal was to have a preliminary working desktop version by: End of Feb 2009 (This was achieved but only for the Mac and Linux).

We realized that time could be better spent developing a web-based version of the game (and not to further develop a pc version) and that the Mac desktop version would act as testing ground for the server version. (Don can set this up if anyone would like to test the Mac version).

Also, after delving into the code, it was clear that more cleanup was necessary. Years of SimCity development had left the code in a dilapidated state and without any documentation. Fortuitously, Albert Hofkamp (TU/e) volunteered to help with cleanup and has been working closely with Don on this.(a list of the cleanup work done by Don and Albert will be distributed). The focus on code cleanup and documentation shows a long term view which will make the project both more scalable, maintainable, readable, open, and extensible (efficiencies critical for countries with limited bandwidth).

Future Development

We plan to have a working preliminary server version ready by: the end of April 2009. Which will include basic tools, tabs, menus.

The next version after that will be end of May and will include chat and avatars (but will not be multiplayer – as this is much more complicated and will be incorporated into a future version). We will also plan our next official MEP meeting for around this time.

Long term goals include:

- Multiplayer
- Sound
- Overlays
- Video
- Wiki integration
- Educational tools
- Web 2.0 Community (discussion groups, blogs, rss feeds, web apis, content sharing, rating, reporting objectionable content, tagging, etc.)

Statistics

Number of lines of code written or refurbished so far:

Simulator, C++, SWIG	45945
Tile Engine, C++, SWIG	6551
Web Server, Python	22351
Laszlo Interface, JavaScript, XML	3579
	======
Total	78426

Summary

The decision to change the focus of the project from an OLPC based environment to a server based one, has resulted in some delay in producing deliverables for the pc but Don and I firmly believe that this decision will ultimately produce better long term results and will make it much simpler for anyone wishing to use the MEP environment to do so and will have the added bonus of being scalable and more efficient.

> Don's presentation